FROM WASHINGTON TO FOREIGN OFFICE

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FOREIGN OFFICE AND
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Sir O. Franks
No. 3900
18th December, 1951.

D. 9.59 p.m. 18th December, 1951.
R. 6.45 a.m. 19th December, 1951.

IMMEDIATE
SECRET

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 3900 of 18th December.
Repeated for information to Tokyo.

Your telegram No. 6119: Japan's Relations with China.

I saw Acheson for over an hour this morning and developed the case made in your telegram under reference with vigour.

2. I particularly concentrated on three points. First, while it was reasonable that Japan should in due course make business arrangements with the Chinese on Formosa we were seriously perturbed at Dulles' desire to transform these business arrangements into a major political act by embodying them in a peace treaty with the Nationalist Government of the Republic of China. Secondly, we did not think that any arrangements with the Chinese on Formosa should be decided upon or made before the ratification of the Japanese Peace Treaty. Thirdly, we thought it inconsistent with the general understandings between the British and American Governments about the treatment of China in relation to Japan that Dulles should press the Japanese towards action in either or both of these directions. Further such pressure before the ratification of the peace treaty was likely, in our opinion, to affect deleteriously the long-term course of Japanese-American relations and, therefore, Japanese/British also.

3. Acheson clearly felt himself in a difficult position. He was acutely aware of the real difficulties which could easily arise in securing ratification of the peace treaty by the American Senate and was most reluctant to take any action which might weaken the hand Dulles had to play on his return from Japan. He referred more than once to the presence of Senators Sparkman and Smith with Dulles in Japan and the importance he attached to these Senators feeling satisfied that the future course of Japan

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SECRET

Washington telegram No. 3900 to Foreign Office

2.

in relation to China was sufficiently satisfactory to them to enable them to defend the treaty on the floor of the Senate.

4. At the same time Acheson was anxious to find a way in which he could reach accommodation with your views because he recognised the importance which you attached to them.

5. The upshot is that a cable is being sent to Dulles setting out the case I made, the difficulties which Acheson talked about and, finally, requesting Dulles to suggest a compromise position which would take account of our views together with his assessment of his chances in getting such a compromise accepted by the Senate.

Please pass Tokyo as my telegram No. 157.

[Repeated to Tokyo.]

ADVANCE COPIES:
Sir W. Strang
Private Secretary
Mr. R.H. Scott
Head of Japan and Pacific Department
Head of China and Korea Department.

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